

Leyao Wang

New Haven, CT | leyao.wang.lw855@yale.edu | (949) 508-6809
Website | Google Scholar | LinkedIn

EDUCATION

• Yale University

Master of Science, Computer Science | Co-advisors: Dr. Arman Cohan, Dr. Rex Ying
◦ Full Scholarship + Teaching Fellowship
◦ Research Areas: Agent RL, Trustworthy LLMs, Alignment

New Haven, CT
Aug 2025 – May 2027

• Vanderbilt University

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science & Mathematics | Minor: Data Science
◦ GPA: 3.99/4.00;
◦ Honors: *summa cum laude* (Top 5%), Dean's List all semesters

Nashville, TN
Aug 2022 – May 2025

• University of California, Irvine

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science
◦ GPA: 4.00/4.00;
◦ Honors: Dean's List all quarters

Irvine, CA
Sep 2021 – Jun 2022

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

• YaleNLP Lab, Yale University

Graduate Researcher | Co-advisor: Dr. Arman Cohan
◦ Focus: Long-horizon Agent Evaluation; LLM/Agent Post-training

New Haven, CT
May 2025 – Present

• Graph and Geometric Learning Lab, Yale University

Graduate Researcher | Co-advisor: Dr. Rex Ying
◦ Focus: LLM Personalization; LLM/Agent Memory

New Haven, CT
May 2025 – Present

• Network and Data Science Lab, Vanderbilt University

Undergraduate Researcher | Advisor: Dr. Tyler Derr
◦ Focus 1: LLM-based Data Augmentation [Paper 1] [Paper 2]
◦ Focus 2: LLM Personalization [Paper 2] [Paper 4] [Paper 5]
◦ Focus 3: Trustworthy AI [Paper 6]

Nashville, TN
Jan 2024 – Aug 2025

• Chatterjee Lab, Duke University

Undergraduate Researcher | Advisor: Dr. Pranam Chatterjee
◦ Focus: AI4Science; LLM Post-training [Paper 7]

Remote
May 2024 – Dec 2024

• Computer Science and Artificial Intelligence Laboratory, MIT

Research Assistant | Mentor: Dr. Wenqiang Chen
◦ Focus: Multi-modality; HCI [Paper 8]

Remote
Mar 2024 – May 2024

• SPHERE Lab, Vanderbilt University

Undergraduate Researcher | Advisor: Dr. Zhijun Yin
◦ Focus: LLM for Health [Paper 9]

Nashville, TN
Apr 2023 – Apr 2024

PATENTS AND PUBLICATIONS

C=CONFERENCE, W=WORKSHOP, J=JOURNAL, S=IN SUBMISSION

- [S.1] Leyao Wang*, Yanan He*, Peng Chen, Asaf Yehudai, Yixin Liu, Rex Ying, Michal Shmueli-Scheuer, Arman Cohan. [Time to REFLECT: Can We Trust LLM Judges for Evidence-based Research Agents](#). (preprint)
- [S.2] Xutao Mao, Liangjie Zhao, Leyao Wang, Rui Qian, Qiang Huang, Wentao Wang, Bo Han, Xiang Zheng, Cong Wang. [Agents Don't Just Agree, They Remember: Benchmarking Persistent Sycophancy in Stateful Personal Agents](#). (preprint)
- [S.3] Leyao Wang*, Xutao Mao*, Xuhui Zhan, Yuying Zhao, Bo Ni, Ryan A. Rossi, Nesreen K. Ahmed, Tyler Derr. [Towards Bridging Review Sparsity in Recommendation with Textual Edge Graph Representation](#). (preprint)
- [S.4] Bo Ni, Branislav Kveton, Samyadeep Basu, Subhojyoti Mukherjee, Leyao Wang, ... Ryan A. Rossi, Tyler Derr. [Reasoning-Based Personalized Generation for Sparse Users](#). (preprint)
- [S.5] Bo Ni, Zheyuan Liu[†], Leyao Wang[†], Yongjia Lei[†], ... Yu Wang*, Meng Jiang*, Tyler Derr*. [Towards Trustworthy Retrieval Augmented Generation for Large Language Models: A Survey](#). (preprint)

[S.6] Jindong Li, Ying Liu, Yali Fu, Jinjing Zhu, **Leyao Wang**, Menglin Yang, Rex Ying **SRTJ: Self-Evolving Rule-Driven Training-Free LLM Jailbreaking**. (preprint / in submission)

[C.1] Yangtian Zhang*, **Leyao Wang***, Hiren Madhu, Ngoc Bui, Walter Roznyatovskiy, Rex Ying. **CoPersona: Collaborative Persona Graphs for Robust LLM Personalization**. *KDD* 2026.

[C.2] **Leyao Wang**, Yu Wang, Bo Ni, Yuying Zhao, Hanyu Wang, Yao Ma, Tyler Derr. **SaVe-TAG: LLM-based Interpolation for Long-Tailed Text-Attributed Graphs**. *KDD* 2026.

[C.3] Xutao Mao, Ezra Xuanru Tao, **Leyao Wang**. **MindVote: When AI Meets the Wild West of Social Media Opinion**. *AAAI* 2026 (**Oral**).

[C.4] Bo Ni, **Leyao Wang**, ..., Tyler Derr, Ryan A Rossi. **Large Language Models for Conversational User Simulation: A Comprehensive Survey**. *EACL* 2026.

[J.1] **Leyao Wang***, Zhiyu Wan*, Congning Ni, Qingyuan Song, Yang Li, Ellen W. Clayton, Bradley Malin, Zhijun Yin. **Application and Concerns of ChatGPT and Conversational Large Language Models in Healthcare: A Systematic Review**. *JMIR*.

[J.2] Wenqiang Chen*, Jason Cheng*, **Leyao Wang**, Wei Zhao, Wojciech Matusik (2024). **Sensor2Text: Enabling Natural Language Interactions for Daily Activity Tracking Using Wearable Sensors**. *IMWUT*.

[W.1] **Leyao Wang***, Rishab Pulugurta*, Pranay Vure*, Yinuo Zhang*, Aastha Pal, Pranam Chatterjee (2024). **PepDoRA: A Unified Peptide Language Model via Weight-Decomposed Low-Rank Adaptation**. *AIDrugX @ NeurIPS* 2024.

Notes: * equal contribution; † alphabetical co-first/co-equal as noted.

WORK EXPERIENCE

- **Institute for Software Integrated Systems (ISIS), Vanderbilt University** Nashville, TN
Research Intern | Advisor: Prof. Gautam Biswas Apr 2024 – Jun 2024
 - Project: Audio Transcription with WhisperX; Sentiment and affect detection with GPT-4o
 - Research Focus: Multi-modality; LLM for sentiment detection;
- **Metissa.AI (Remote)** Remote
Research & Development Intern Apr 2023 – Aug 2023
 - Project: OpenAI-powered chatbot (GPT-3.5) for AP Exam questions
 - Research Focus: RAG, LLM Customization

HONORS AND AWARDS

- **Dean’s Award for Outstanding Scholarship** May 2025
Vanderbilt School of Engineering
 - For achieving *summa cum laude* distinction ($GPA \geq$ top 5% of the previous three years’ graduating seniors).
- **Honorable Mention, CRA Outstanding Undergraduate Award** Jan 2025
Computing Research Association
 - For undergraduate students in North America who show outstanding potential in computing research.
- **Vanderbilt University Summer Research Program (VUSRP)** Apr 2024
Vanderbilt University
 - Stipend: \$6000.
- **Data Science Institute Research Program** Apr 2024
Vanderbilt University
 - Stipend: \$6000 (declined due to accepting VUSRP).
- **ISIS Summer Internship Program** Apr 2024
Institute for Software Integrated Systems
 - Stipend: \$8000 (declined due to accepting VUSRP).

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

- **Program Committee:** AAAI ’26
- **Conference (Sub)Reviewer:** KDD ’25; ACL ’26; MLoG-GenAI@KDD ’25
- **Journal Reviewer:** TKDD; TAI;JMIR
- **Teaching Assistant:** Trustworthy DL (*Yale*); Intro to LLM (*Yale*); Stats and Prob (*Vanderbilt*)

TECHNICAL SKILLS & INTERESTS

- **Programming Languages:** Python, C++, Java, HTML/CSS, JavaScript (React.js), MySQL, R, Linux
- **Research Interests:** Human-AI Collaboration, Agent RL, LLM Post-training, Trustworthy AI